

Global Politics News Analysis
LeeAnne English-Stewart
POSC 200, James Madison University

News Analysis for Week 2

The event that I will be discussing this week is the Anti-ICE protests occurring in Milan. With the Winter Olympics beginning in Italy soon, the people of Italy have come together to protest the presence of ICE Agents during the competition. ICE agents have attended the Olympics in Italy before, but not while carrying out their duties in the same way they are today. Due to the recent violence from ICE, specifically in Minnesota, Italy wants to stand against ICE and declare them not welcome, regardless of the Olympics.

This week, I read two articles on these protests, one published by NPR, a left-leaning site, and Fox News, a right-leaning site. The first thing that caught my attention in the Fox News article was how brief it was. This article is barely a 2-minute read and spares a lot of details, especially regarding the actions of ICE in Minneapolis. The only reference the Fox News article made to ICE in Minneapolis was repeating what the people of Milan said. Fox News also highlighted that the Italian Interior Minister said that he did not see what the problem would be with ICE attending the Olympics, as well as a statement put out by DHS saying ICE would not conduct immigration enforcement while being in another country. On the contrary, NPR shared a statement from the head of the Italian Democratic Party's Milan chapter, who stated that the protest isn't just for the Olympic Games; they have a bigger meaning of justice in the world. This article also gave details on the people killed by ICE agents, as well as the photos/videos they have seen showing exactly how violent the ICE agents operated in Minneapolis. While these articles both frame the protests in different ways, they share the same simple fact of Milan having protests against ICE attending the Winter Olympics.

In my opinion, I do not believe that ICE should be able to attend the Winter Olympics in Milan. Especially if Milan's mayor is saying they are not welcome. While Italy is often an ally of the US, bringing in ICE when they are unwanted could create further issues between the nations. I also support Milan's protest against the violent actions ICE took against innocent Minneapolis residents. Kelley and Chasman's interview further supports the protest in Milan by describing how terrifying and unjust Good's murder was and how it is an unfortunate common story in America that needs to be fought against (Kelley & Chasman, 2026). While it is a tragic story, it is nice to see other countries protesting the presence of ICE agents and their actions. Even

though Fox News tried to portray Italians as dumb for thinking ICE would detain people in another country, they missed the bigger picture highlighted by NPR – global justice.

News Analysis for Week 4

The event that I will analyze based on different news outlets this week is the Munich Security Conference. This Conference began on February 13th and will continue through the 15th, and gives executive leaders the opportunity to discuss the world's most relevant security issues.

These articles cover Marco Rubio's presence at the Security Conference and reflect the values the opposing publishers have. One of the main topics of this year's Munich Security Conference so far has seemed to be the tension between Trump and Europe.

This week I will be analyzing an article published by the Guardian, a left-leaning news outlet, and Fox News, a right-leaning news outlet. These two articles had very obvious biases regarding the Trump administration. The Fox News article focuses on how Marco Rubio represented the administration and shared a lot about how strong it is. The way the article is written, it seems as though Rubio used this opportunity as a way to brag about the Trump administration's leadership compared to other nations. The Guardian article has a bias against Rubio, concluding the article by describing how he skipped a meeting and barely mentioned Ukraine. Another main difference

between the two articles was that the Guardian shared European leaders' reaction to Rubio's statements, while Fox News did not. In the Fox News article, Rubio is framed as a trusted leader to share America's message in another nation, while the Guardian framed Rubio as a puppet to work on carrying out Trump's priorities. Another key difference between the two articles is that the Guardian discussed Europe as trying to protect the balance of their alliance with the U.S., and

Fox News makes it seem like Europe is a place that America still has strong influence over. Although these articles give insight into the same person and global event, they couldn't be more opposite in the way they decide to describe the words shared.

After reading the two articles, I believe that Rubio was delivering his speech with a bias that is pro-Trump administration. His language came across as trying to reassure European leaders while making it evident that cooperation would only happen under the political priorities of the current Trump administration. While Fox News attempted to frame Rubio as a strong American leader, the Guardian acknowledged why some European leaders would be, and were, cautious about fully accepting his message. In "The Origins of Alliances" Stephen Walt emphasizes that alliances are strongest when countries view their interests as aligned and face common threats.

This supports my argument by explaining why European leaders may hesitate in fully agreeing with the current American administration's differing political priorities from those of Europe.

News Analysis for Week 5

The recent news that I will be discussing this week is a study that found the death toll in Gaza to be much higher than what was originally reported. After the first year and few months of the Israeli-Palestinian conflict, it was reported that a little under 50,000 Palestinian people were killed. A new study conducted by the Lancet Global Health medical journal found that it was really over 75,000 Palestinian people who were killed during that time. The initial death toll was discovered by the Palestinian health ministry. The articles explained how the first study was misinformed, and the death toll is most likely more than the current 75,000 reported.

The articles that I read for this week were published by the Guardian (left-leaning) and Reuters (centrist). The Reuters article was very straightforward and only shared information that came directly from other people and studies. The author didn't offer any opinions of their own. I also found it interesting that at the end of the article, there was a link to the Thomson Reuters Trust Principles, which takes you to a page sharing their obligation for employees to act with freedom from bias. The Guardian article shared the same data and facts as the Reuters article, except that Reuters discussed the first 15 months of war, and the Guardian discussed the first 16 months. They also both discuss how extreme the miscalculation was. The Guardian article frames this article about the death toll miscalculation to speak against Israel. One example of this bias is prevalent when the article shared that this new study goes directly against Israeli officials' claims, and another example is shown in the language they use around Israel's attacks on Gaza. The Guardian article used words like "devastating", "lethal", and "assault" when describing the way Israel acted. It was interesting to read the article published by Reuters and see no form of bias, but rather simple facts about an event that took place. I also appreciated the fact that the data presented by both articles were almost identical because I feel like this should always be the case, no matter the publication's political beliefs.

For this week's news analysis, I feel like it is hard for me to form an exact opinion on the matter of the death tolls; however, I do believe I can form an analysis on the difference between the sources and the importance of needing correct death tolls in a conflict or war. Both articles reflect that it is necessary to have correct, official numbers when examining death tolls in conflict. In research conducted during humanitarian emergencies, it was found that death tolls are

important because they help to paint a clearer picture of the human impact of conflict, especially when the numbers are being debated by different sides (Checchi & Roberts, 2008). While the Guardian article presented more bias against Israel, both articles shared necessary data to assess the ongoing conflict between Israel and Palestine.

News Analysis for Week 7

The event that I will be discussing this week is the US submarine that sank an Iranian ship. This sinking is a very significant event for America because it is the first attack of this nature since World War II. It is unclear whether the strike was necessary or not, but the event was confirmed in a Pentagon press briefing this Wednesday.

The articles that I used for this week's analysis were published by Military Times (supposed to be centrist) and Al Jazeera (left-leaning). While Military Times relayed information similar to the centrist publisher Reuters, I found the article to have some right-leaning bias, as it spoke about this strike down as something to be proud of. The article shared a quote from Chief of Staff Gen. Caine stating, "This is an incredible demonstration of America's global reach. To hunt, find, and kill, an out-of-area deployer...." While the article is simply sharing what Caine said, it never stated that this was not an event that makes was an incredible demonstration on America's end. With the article published by Al Jazeera, I found bias in the description of the broader conflict, where schoolgirls were murdered, and the large number of civilian casualties that occurred in the sinking and other air strikes. This article frames the Iranian ship sinking event as a reflection of U.S. military aggression rather than something the military should be proud of. Some common factors among these articles are the number of people aboard the Iranian ship (180), the mention of Pete Hegseth giving a press conference on the matter, and explaining that this was the first attack of this nature since World War II. While neither of these articles was very obvious with their biases, it was interesting to see how differently they were framed against the opposite nations.

While I am still unclear whether the attack was necessary or not, these articles have made it clear that the way the news is framed can influence which nation is viewed as the "bad guy" in a situation. I do not agree with the way the Military Times article framed this event as something America should be proud of, although I do see the importance of the post-WWII time frame. I think the Military Times article should've at least discussed how many people were killed on the Iranian ship because of the American submarine, similarly to how Al Jazeera did. In Mueller's "The Iraq Syndrome", he describes American public opinion around different wars and explains that without proper justification, people will disagree with America's actions. He gets into detail

on just how much framing can affect the public's opinion on events, and this is prevalent when the Military Times frames the current strike as a demonstration of strength, while Al Jazeera frames it as another example of the U.S. military using too much aggression.

News Analysis for Week 8

For this week's global news topic, I will be exploring articles that discuss the recent increase in the price of gas. Data supplied by AAA show that gas and diesel prices have continuously increased across America over the past couple of days, more than they have in the last few months. This is due to the fact that we are currently in conflict with Iran. Since there is a key oil source on Iran's border, the price for gas and diesel has increased because of the difficulty of getting oil from this area.

The articles I found for this week are from Fox News, a right-leaning news outlet, and the NY Times, a left-leaning news outlet. They both used AAA as a source when showing the rising gas prices in different states. They also both said that prices rose by about \$100 a barrel. The NY Times article went into a lot more depth and specifics about the gasoline and diesel prices rising, while the Fox News article just made a brief statement. This seems to be a common theme for Fox News. The NY Times also used personal stories from people in the US and how their lives have been affected by this change. Fox News didn't share any personal stories but instead shared that this price increase is exactly what the Democrats have been eager to exploit. One personal story the NY Times shared was of a man living in Chicago who noticed that gas prices began to rise immediately once Trump began bombing Iran. Another story shared by the NY Times is of a civilian who blames Trump for the rise in gas prices because of his decision to attack Iran. The Fox News article never acknowledges the tie between Trump's attack on Iran and the price increases, but they share that Trump said he would hit Iran much harder if they tried to intervene with the world's oil supply. One piece of information that was beneficial in Fox News and not the New York Times was a description of where the Strait of Hormuz (the oil supply on the coast of Iran) is located and how any conflict that occurs near this region can disrupt markets, but again never mentioned who was at fault for this conflict.

In my opinion, the recent gas price influx is directly due to Trump is attacking and openly threatening Iran. One research study conducted simulations of a US-Iran war and the impact different war levels would have on oil price behavior. The study ultimately found that oil prices increase even when there is moderate conflict between the US and Iran (Ruiz et al., 2020). While Fox News and the NY Times have obvious bias throughout their articles, they both have the

same data showing the recent increase in gas prices and touch on the conflict in Iran being the source of this. I found the personal stories to be a great addition to the NY Times article because it gives insight into how the American people are affected by this rise in pricing. I also found it interesting that this article referenced Trump as “Mr. Trump” and not the president. I didn’t like how the Fox News article didn’t flat-out state who was at fault for the US-Iran conflict, but they were quick to share how this price change is exactly what Democrats have been waiting for. After reading these articles and an outside source, I believe Trump is the main reason for our current conflict in Iran, thus our recent gas price increase.

References:

Week 2

Kelley, R. D. G., & Chasman, D. (2026). *Renee Good's murder and other acts of Terror - Boston Review*. Renee Good's Murder and Other Acts of Terror.

<https://www.bostonreview.net/articles/renee-goods-murder-and-other-acts-of-terror/>

Mann, B. (2026, January 31). *Milan protesters call for U.S. ICE agents to leave Italy as Winter Games approach*. NPR.

<https://www.npr.org/2026/01/31/nx-s1-5695197/as-winter-olympics-milan-protesters-call-for-ice-agents-to-leave-italy>

Morik, R. (2026, January 31). *Anti-ICE protests erupt in Milan ahead of Winter Olympics over planned agent deployment*. Fox News.

<https://www.foxnews.com/sports/anti-ice-protests-erupt-milan-ahead-winter-olympics-over-planned-agent-deployment>

Week 4

Colton, E. (2026, February 13). *Rubio steps into Munich spotlight as Trump leans on him to carry Vance's populist message abroad*. Fox News.

<https://www.foxnews.com/politics/rubio-steps-munich-spotlight-trump-leans-him-carry-vances-populist-message-abroad>

Walt, S. M. (1987). Introduction: Exploring Alliance Formation. In *The Origins of Alliances* (pp. 1–16). Cornell University Press. <http://www.jstor.org/stable/10.7591/j.ctt32b5fc.5>

Wintour, P. (2026, February 14). *Rubio tells Europe US wants Renewed Alliance – but on Trump's terms*. The Guardian.

<https://www.theguardian.com/us-news/2026/feb/14/marco-rubio-us-child-of-europe-trump-munich>

Week 5

Ayyub, R. (2026, February 19). *Gaza deaths in war's first 15 months higher than reported, study says* | Reuters. Reuters.

<https://www.reuters.com/world/middle-east/gaza-deaths-wars-first-15-months-higher-than-reported-study-says-2026-02-19/>

Burke, J. (2026, February 18). *Gaza death toll for first 16 months of war far higher than reported, says peer-reviewed study*. The Guardian.

<https://www.theguardian.com/world/2026/feb/19/gaza-death-toll-higher-than-reported-lancet-study>

Checchi, F., & Roberts, L. (2008). Documenting mortality in crises: What keeps us from doing better? *PLoS Medicine*, 5(7). <https://doi.org/10.1371/journal.pmed.0050146>

Week 7

Al Jazeera. (2026, March 4). *US submarine sank Iran's warship off Sri Lanka Coast, says Hegseth*. Al Jazeera.

<https://www.aljazeera.com/news/2026/3/4/at-least-100-missing-after-iranian-military-ship-sinks-off-sri-lanka-coast>

Mueller, J. (2005). The Iraq syndrome. *Foreign Affairs*, 84(6), 44.

<https://doi.org/10.2307/20031775>

Simkins, J. D., & Ceder, R. (2026, March 5). *US submarine sinks Iranian ship in first torpedo kill since WWII, Pentagon confirms*. Military Times.

<https://www.militarytimes.com/news/your-military/2026/03/04/us-submarine-sinks-iranian-ship-in-first-torpedo-kill-since-wwii-pentagon-confirms/>

Week 8

Burch, A. D. S. (2026, March 10). *As Iran war spikes gas prices, Americans struggle with the rising cost of living* - The New York Times. The New York Times.

<https://www.nytimes.com/2026/03/10/us/gas-prices-iran-war-cost-of-living.html>

Macias, A. (2026, March 10). *Gas prices surge, pinching Americans and handing the GOP a new midterm headache*. Fox News.

<https://www.foxnews.com/politics/gas-prices-surge-pinching-americans-handing-gop-new-midterm-headache>

Ruiz Estrada, M. A., Park, D., Tahir, M., & Khan, A. (2020). Simulations of US-Iran war and its impact on global oil price behavior. *Borsa Istanbul Review*, 20(1), 1-12.

<https://doi.org/10.1016/j.bir.2019.11.002>